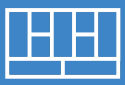
CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIP STRATEGIES

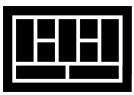


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SUPER GUIDE:
CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIP STRATEGIES

BY DANIEL PEREIRA



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Daniel Pereira
The Business Model Analyst Ottawa, ON, Canada
businessmodelanalyst.com

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

Introduction 8

What Is Customer Relationship On Business Canvas? 10

The Importance Of Customer Relationships Block On Business Canvas 12

Strategies To Acquire, Retain, And Grow Customers 13

- Customer Acquisition 13
  - Content Marketing 13
  - Email Marketing 14
  - Social Media Marketing 14
  - Search Engine Optimization 14
  - Copywriting 14
  - Conversion Rate Optimization 14
  - Analytics 15
- Customer Retention 15
  - Defending A Point Of View 15
  - Invoking The Ego 15
  - Reducing Pain 16
  - Offering Extra Benefits 16
  - Making It Personal 16
  - Maintaining Quality 16
  - Choosing The Communication Channel 17
  - Utilize Positive Social Proof 17
  - Use The Words They Love To Hear 17
  - Realize That Budget Is Negligible 17
  - Speed Is Secondary To The Quality 17

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Customers Enjoy Businesses That Know Them 17
Make It A Communal Effort 18
Get People Started 18
Get Ideal Customers To Be Vips 18
Label Your Customers 18
Boosting Sales (Upselling) 18

Types Of Customer Relationships 20
Self-Service 20
Automated Services 21
Communities 21
Personal Assistance 22
Dedicated Personal Assistance 22
Co-Creation 22

Customer Relations: The Importance And How To Create Strong Relationships 24
Understand And Meet Your Customers' Hierarchy Of Needs 25
Customer Relations Vs Customer Service 27
The Importance Of Strong Customer Relationships 28
Reduces Customer Turnover 28
Improves Customer Loyalty 28
Increases The Customer Lifetime Value (Clv) 29
18 Ways To Build Strong Customer Relationships 29
1 - Communicate 29
2 - Exceed Expectations 30
3 - Ask For Feedback 30
4 - Connect 31
5 - Show Appreciation 31
6 - Understand The Customer Journey 31
7 - Introduce Yourself To The Customer 32

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8 - Implement Crm Software Tools 32
9 - Market Your Customer Service Perks 32
10 - Match Customer Habits 33
11 - Respond Right Away 33
12 - Set Consistent Quality Controls 33
13 - Follow Up Regularly 33
14 - Personalize All Communications 34
15 - Keep Detailed Customer Files 34
16 - Prioritize Customer Experience 35
17 - Create Value For Customers 35
18 - Instill Customer Service Etiquette 36

Viral Loop **39**

Case Study **40**
Starbucks 40
Google Vs. Facebook In Customer Relationships 40

Conclusion **43**

References **44**

About The Author **46**

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INTRODUCTION

One of the most productive techniques that a business can employ is to establish a relationship with its clients in order to maximize its profits.

Despite the fact that it plays a critical role in both growth and retention, regrettably, it is also one that is often overlooked. By boosting customer loyalty, contentment, and retention, a wonderful approach to developing customer relationships may result in a significant increase in return on investment.

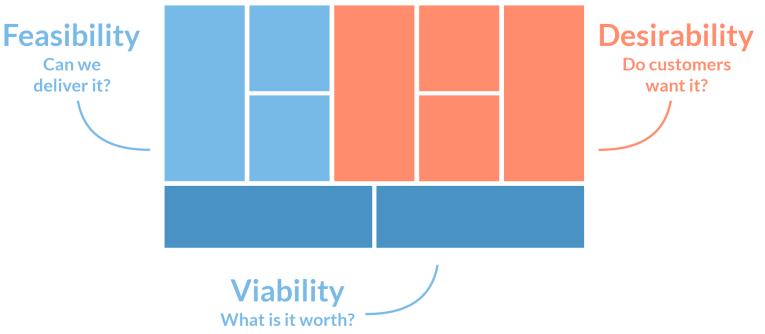
The key to success is effectively managing communications with all of your customers, both current and future. Successful businesses understand that investing in the experiences of their customers is essential not just to retain their present customers, but also to attract new ones. It is essential to keep in mind that each and every interaction with a customer will have some kind of effect on the relationship between the two parties.

Because of this, providing excellent service to customers should be everyone's primary focus, notwithstanding the position they have within the company.

Either proactive or reactive steps might be used in order to improve relationships with existing or potential consumers. One example of a proactive plan would be to disseminate a press release that describes your brand-new product in depth. It would be a reactive action to send an apology letter and a discount to customers who were unhappy with the service they received.

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In this super guide, we're going to talk about the fundamentals of customer relations, including what customer relations really are, as well as the reasons why it's critical for your company to develop a successful customer relationship strategy.



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WHAT IS CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIP ON BUSINESS CANVAS?

The Customer Profile component on Business Model Canvases places an emphasis on both the logical and irrational parts of customers' decision-making, drawing on both neurolinguistic programming and psychology studies of motivation and choice architecture. However, in contrast to other models of decision-making, this one does not presume that people are equally motivated by either gain or pain in the same way across the population.

For the vast majority of novel concepts and young businesses, growth is a challenge. Increasing expenditure on marketing won't have much of an effect if the solution's fit with the market isn't optimal. In order for businesses to have a better understanding of their customers, which, in turn, will increase the solution's compatibility with the market, an ongoing outside-in strategy is required. Instead of thinking you already know what your target audience wants, ask them directly.

During the process of cultivating the perfect relationship with their customers, businesses should, in essence, put themselves in the shoes of the target demographic of customers. In what ways would they consider this to be the perfect relationship? Will developing the relationship be done by computer, will it be done personally, or will it be a

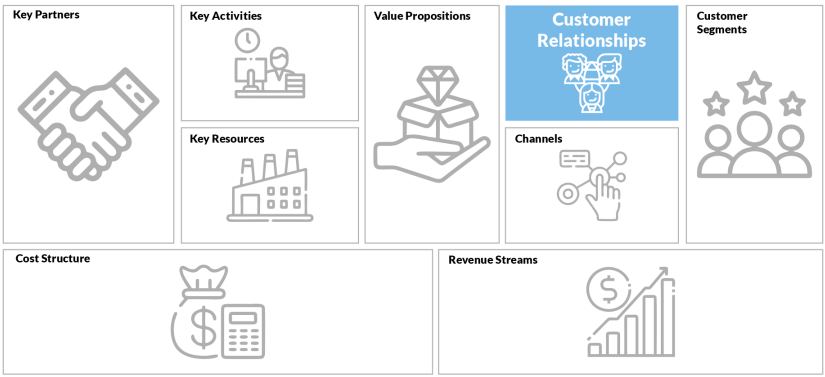
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combination of the two? When developing relationships with customers, it is important to keep in mind that customers have certain criteria that they expect companies to fulfill.

Furthermore, the quality of interactions with customers has a direct bearing on the degree to which those customers are satisfied with the service they get. Customers who feel that their needs are consistently met throughout a company's many touchpoints are more likely to remain devoted to that organization and to its products or services. Through these connections, it is possible to win over new consumers, and existing ones may be upsold and cross-sold in more products to drive up overall revenue.

In this portion of the Business Model Canvas, the company has to ask itself these key questions:

- What kind of relationship with our company does each of our client subgroups anticipate having?
- Which of these relationships has been formed already?
- What is the price for these?
- How well do their operations fit within the framework of our business?



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THE IMPORTANCE OF CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIPS BLOCK ON BUSINESS CANVAS

You are a big company, which means that you have access to a variety of resources; as a result, the goal is to stop concentrating on the things that you do not have and to make the most of the things that you do have. You undoubtedly have access to a broad range of useful resources, such as a well-known brand and customers, deep industry knowledge, purchasing power, distribution channels and partnerships, financial backing, and many more.

None of these factors are typical of a new business, and it's likely that your competitors don't have any of them either. If you know how to make effective use of them, you could give yourself an unfair edge.

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STRATEGIES TO ACQUIRE, RETAIN, AND GROW CUSTOMERS

CUSTOMER ACQUISITION

To win over new customers, you need to convince them that they should purchase the products or services offered by your firm rather than those offered by other businesses in your industry. Many of an organization's efforts are devoted to determining the value of a customer in comparison to the cost of acquiring that customer.

Entrepreneurs in today's society who are innovative may utilize a broad array of methods and sales channels to discover new customers. The next paragraphs will go into more depth about these channels.

Content Marketing
This is an excellent alternative for new businesses that are just getting started and have a very limited budget. Extremely effective, but only when used intelligently and judiciously. The method makes use of SEO (Search Engine Optimization), which improves the visibility of a page or website in search results by increasing the relevance of its content to a specific search query.

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Email marketing
Its effectiveness is increased when combined with search engine optimization (SEO) and content marketing. If a potential customer signs up to get emails from your company, for instance, you may communicate with them without having to spend money on a sales team.

Social Media Marketing
Even while social media has become a more valuable tool for increasing the size of your customer base, using it on its own is not enough to get the word out about your product. However, when paired with other marketing tactics, social media may work wonders for the reputation of your product among the audience you are trying to reach.

Search Engine Optimization
When you participate in content marketing, it is inevitable that your name as well as any information on your company or brand will be shared on the internet. It is a wonderful approach to boost the exposure of your content in search engines by extensively sharing it. This, in turn, raises the possibility that your target audience will come across your product.

Copywriting
Your choice of words has a big influence on how consumers will perceive your brand and how they will interact with the products it offers. You have the option of hiring copywriters to aid you in establishing your firm in the market and attracting the consumers you wish to work with.

Conversion Rate Optimization
You may be able to boost the number of customers who patronize your company if you make a few tweaks to the way the content and the strategy as a whole are presented.

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Analytics

It is not enough to just tell people about your products through the methods listed above. Companies aren't getting the most out of their investment if they aren't analyzing the information they've gathered from these various sources in order to get a deeper understanding of their target demographics and how they shop.

CUSTOMER RETENTION

Customer retention is accomplished when a company is able to effectively establish long-lasting relationships with the individuals who comprise its customer base. When a company has a large group of loyal customers, there is a greater chance that they will also be brand advocates who are eager to talk positively about the business and the products it sells.

The following are some strategies that businesses may use in order to retain their existing customers and build long-lasting relationships with those customers.

Defending a point of view

Brands that consumers can identify with, either in themselves or in people they look up to, or in the firms they like, tend to inspire more loyalty from those consumers. Thus, it is crucial for a business to articulate to its target audience the values that it intends its brand to represent.

Invoking the ego

Customers want to have the impression that their purchases are an accurate representation of who they are. If your product, for example, helps consumers improve their social status in any manner, they will have a greater interest in purchasing it. To do this, you must first get an understanding of what it is that your customer really desires, then develop

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rapport with them, and last show how your product represents an idealized version of who they actually are. In order to better serve their customers, organizations often break up their consumers into a number of distinct groups.

Reducing pain
If the problems that your product really solves are those that are faced by the customer, then your rates of customer retention will be much improved. There is a better chance that this particular person will "market" your business to many other people who are going through issues that are comparable to their own.

Offering extra benefits
When a customer is given an unexpected benefit, such as a price discount or a free bonus, they have a greater propensity to purchase from that business again.

Making it personal
By providing individualized, tailored service to each client, you may increase the likelihood that they will remain loyal to your company. When a member of staff interacts with a client, that is what takes place. In either scenario, the customer is under the impression that they have already developed a personal relationship with the company, since they have the impression that the business already knows them.

In addition, the desire to win is built into the nature of every human being. The probability that a client will continue to use your product or service after being elevated to the status of a VIP inside your company by providing them with special treatment is significantly increased.

Maintaining quality
Contrary to what many businesses assume, the client cares more about quality and not quantity or speed in a product or service. Maintaining a level of quality that is consistently high

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is the most effective method for demonstrating to one's clientele one's appreciation for those clients and for retaining those customers as patrons.

Choosing the communication channel
It is crucial to have a good understanding of your customer's preferred form of communication. Increasing the visibility of your brand in the mind of the customer will require that your message be communicated via suitable media.

Utilize positive social proof
If a company's website has information that demonstrates how utilizing the product will increase the client's social status, the consumer is more likely to stay loyal to the company over the long term.

Use the words they love to hear
When a product meets up to the standards that have been set for it, it is much simpler to convince customers to purchase more products.

Realize that budget is negligible
The vast majority of companies are hesitant to provide discounts to their customers, despite the fact that even a little price cut may leave a customer feeling satisfied and inspire him or her to purchase other items.

Speed is secondary to the quality
It is typical for companies to have the erroneous assumption that their consumers would be OK with a lesser quality of service if it can be delivered more quickly. But studies have shown that if a company puts an emphasis on quality, customers are more likely to come back.

Customers enjoy businesses that know them
When an employee takes the time to get to know a customer and tailors their service to meet their specific needs, the

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customer has the impression that the company cares about them as a person and is more likely to continue to be loyal to the brand.

Make it a communal effort
When it comes to meeting the needs of a client, each and every division within your organization has to be actively engaged and informed at all times. Because the whole is larger than the sum of its parts, the overall quality of the experience will be enhanced as a result.

Get people started
If companies can get beyond the initial resistance of their customers to participate in loyalty programs and persuade them to sign up for the programs automatically, they will significantly improve the possibility that their customers will really make use of the programs. Once the momentum has been established, there is a greater likelihood that customers will continue participating in the program.

Get ideal customers to be VIPs
According to a number of studies, customers express a desire to be assigned to a certain customer class if there is another class that sits below them in the company's hierarchy of the program. This is because human beings have a natural tendency to compete with one another.

Label your customers
Consumers are more likely to remain loyal to a brand when they have the perception that they can identify the business that they support.

BOOSTING SALES (UPSELLING)

Upselling is a typical sales strategy in which a representative of a firm offers additional things to a customer in an attempt

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to boost the customer's total purchase. The goal of this strategy is to have the consumer spend more money. Companies may often utilize specific terminology, product packaging, and price reductions, in addition to the sale of dependent things, to increase the likelihood that a customer would purchase more of their product.

It is similar to selling a combo pack consisting of a Coke and fries as well as a protective case that is included with the purchase of the smartphone.

Companies frequently provide incentive programs that financially reward employees who improve sales through upselling, and then urge their colleagues to utilize the same methods. This kind of behavior is seen as beneficial to the company as a whole, since it leads to more revenue. Incentives of this kind are seldom brought up in direct conversations with customers because of the concern that consumers' trust in the company's customer service agents may be harmed in the event that word got out.

If you want to boost your sales, you need to have an in-depth understanding of the demographics of your target market, including the preferences, hopes, and concerns of your customers, as well as any other motives they may have. If you do this, you will likely get additional insight into the tastes of the people that make up your target market.

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TYPES OF CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIPS

Although there are numerous subcategories of customer relationships, the six that are most significant to discuss will be the subject of this section. Inside the structure, they have the option of existing independently or in collaboration with one another.



SELF-SERVICE

Simply put, this relationship in question exemplifies the "transactional" dynamic in its purest form. Think of a self-service kiosk that you may see at an airport; it's meant to be a fast and impersonal way to complete a transaction.

The do-it-yourself strategy is gaining more and more traction as firms search for methods to save costs, the savings from which they intend to pass on to customers in the form of

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cheaper prices. Under the terms of this agreement, the customer is responsible for delivering their own service, and the company will provide any and all tools that may be required.

AUTOMATED SERVICES

When it comes to the convenience of the customer, automated services are superior to self-service in that they provide customers with automated tools and processes. These services often give a greater customized experience to the individual, and in order to provide recommendations to the client, they create a profile of the client's interests by compiling information about their online and shopping patterns. Because of the high level of personalization that is present in automated services, they can be compared favorably to the support provided by humans.

COMMUNITIES

Communities in the present era, which is driven by social media, are wonderful for helping companies learn about their customers, their preferences, as well as their thoughts and ideas, while also offering a space for customers to network with one another and learn from one another.

This not only helps the company interact on a more personal level with its consumers, but it also encourages customers to develop relationships with other customers. A company such as GlaxoSmithKline is an excellent illustration of this point. When the business introduced a new weight-loss medication, it also offered customers a forum where they could communicate with one another and talk about their experiences with the prescription. This helped the company get a better understanding of the challenges that people with

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obesity confront.

PERSONAL ASSISTANCE

The human element is essential to the success of this kind of customer relationship. Customers may discuss their options with a sales representative before making a purchase, and after making a purchase, they can discuss their experience with a member of the customer support staff.

DEDICATED PERSONAL ASSISTANCE

This relationship takes the concept of personalized service to a whole new level by providing the customer with access to a qualified expert who is able to respond to any inquiries or concerns the client may have at any given time.

To establish this type of relationship successfully, a representative requires both time and expertise. The capacity of the representative to rely on their prior experience with the customer in order to customize the customer's contacts with the business to meet their individual requirements is an essential component of this personalization. Many financial institutions accomplish this goal by appointing a single point of contact for their most significant and long-term clients.

CO-CREATION

The conventional relationship between seller and purchaser is undergoing a radical shift as an increasing number of companies include customers in all aspects of the product creation process. Because of this, these customers report a greater sense of investment in the product or service, and as a result, "champions" of the brand or product may emerge in certain cases.

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CUSTOMER RELATIONS: THE IMPORTANCE AND HOW TO CREATE STRONG RELATIONSHIPS

Establishing and maintaining positive relationships with one's customers has always been an essential component of the success of businesses. Before the advent of the internet, the majority of our purchases were made in physical stores. Our relationship with the store's proprietors and employees had a role in determining which products to purchase. The manner in which we spent our money, as well as the timing of those expenditures, was dictated by our sentimental ties, our complex tastes, and our loyalties.

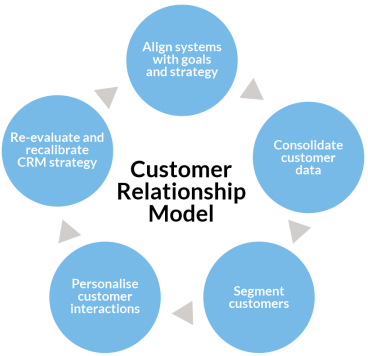
It can appear as if these connections and the era of devoted customers are long gone. That’s not true, however.

Every interaction, whether it takes place online or in person, is an opportunity for successful businesses to forge and continue to cultivate a personal bond with the members of their target audience. Even if a business's customers are only seen in person seldom, if at all, by company personnel, it is essential to the firm's success that these bonds be maintained.

A strategy for preserving cordial interactions with one's customers is necessary for achieving success over the course

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of time. Because of this, it is tough to get by without putting these relationships first.



UNDERSTAND AND MEET YOUR CUSTOMERS' HIERARCHY OF NEEDS

It is hard to build a real and long-term relationship with someone else if you do not take the time to learn about them. The same may be said of one's relationships with their customers. Consider: What is it that your customer wants from you that you can provide? What can you do to be of service to them?

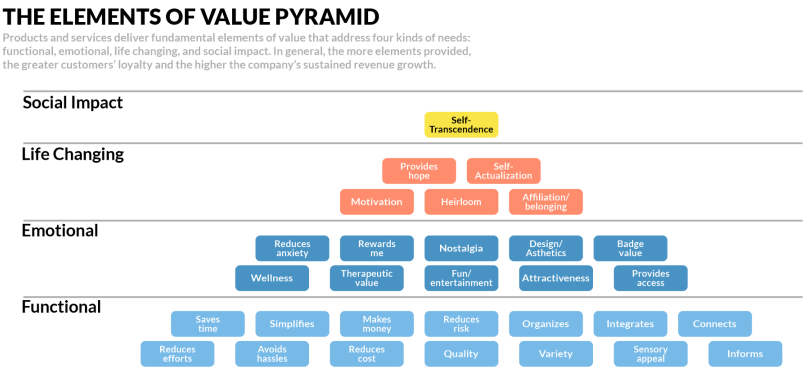
The most trustworthy companies make a concerted effort to put themselves in the position of their customers on a regular basis. They find out what their customers want by conducting polls, focus groups, and other types of market research, in addition to receiving information from customer service personnel, sales representatives, and success representatives.

Developed by Abraham Maslow, the "hierarchy of needs" is a

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model that is often used by marketers. According to Maslow's hierarchy of needs theory, different people have different needs in the areas of physiology (such as the need for food and clothing), safety (needs for job security), love and belonging (social needs), esteem, and self-actualization.

This traditional approach was reimagined by Bain & Company as their very own "Elements of Value" pyramid for the purpose of better comprehending what it is that clients desire most from businesses. As opposed to five, there are just four categories: functional, emotional, changing, and societal. At each of these layers, companies have thirty different opportunities to wow their clients and win their loyalty.



Businesses add the most value to their offerings when they concentrate their efforts not only on the goods or services they provide but also on the ways in which they interact with their customers as a whole. The more you are able to do for your customers, the more devoted they will be to your product, and the more sustainable your business will be in the long run.

If you are able to identify the value that your company brings to its customers, you will be in a better position to service

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those clients. As a result of ongoing advancements in data and technology, personalized fulfillment of "value element" expectations is becoming a more realistic possibility.

CUSTOMER RELATIONS VS CUSTOMER SERVICE

Representatives of the frontline customer service team should be considered the bedrock of any successful customer relationship strategy. Customer service professionals are the ones who directly interact with the majority of the company's customers. As a result of this, they have a unique opportunity to redefine the relationship with their customers. They have the ability to preserve these significant relationships by being reliable and helpful to customers.

When a customer is engaged with your company and the products and services it provides, they will get a greater benefit from those interactions, which will in turn strengthen the relationship between you and that customer. If you give the rock stars of your customer service department greater leeway to do what they do best, they may find innovative and exciting ways to utilize that freedom to enhance the overall experience for the customers.

However, these actions do not take place inside the confines of a particular job or role in isolation. In an ideal world, each employee would act as a watchman for the company's relationship with its clients. Every member of the team not only has the ability but also the responsibility to contribute to the formation of stronger relationships with existing customers.

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THE IMPORTANCE OF STRONG CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIPS

Putting in the time and effort to cultivate relationships with your consumers may bring you numerous rewards, just two of which are an increase in the number of leads generated and a rise in the percentage of customers who choose to remain loyal to your brand. To elaborate, take into consideration the following three significant benefits of building positive relationships with one's customers.

Reduces customer turnover

According to a survey, 61% of customers who have a poor experience with a company will stop making future purchases as a result of that experience. When you utilize the appropriate tactics to nurture relationships with your customers, you can reduce the number of customers that leave your business and increase the likelihood that they will return in the future. If you are able to live up to their expectations, they will not look for a solution somewhere else.

Improves customer loyalty

When compared to the cost of maintaining an existing client base, the cost of acquiring new customers may be up to five times higher. The strength of your relationships with your customers has a direct bearing on the degree to which they will remain loyal to your brand. The satisfaction of one's customers can be raised by giving the superior service that they expect to receive. Customers that are satisfied with your products or services will keep referring your company to their friends.

Increases the customer lifetime value (CLV)

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The longer a person continues to be a client, the greater their lifetime value as a customer will be to the business. If your CLV is higher, you can reasonably anticipate receiving more money from each individual customer. The strength of a company's relationships with its customers is one of the most important factors in determining that company's level of success.

18 WAYS TO BUILD STRONG CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIPS

1 - Communicate
When it comes to developing relationships with customers, maintaining open lines of communication is essential, just as it is in any other kind of productive cooperation. It is important to market your business while also actively listening to what your customers have to say about it.

Instead of just talking to your consumers about your firm, speak to them about themselves and what they need. Find out what it is that your customers are looking for, and then prove to them that you are able to provide it to them.

Train your workers on how to communicate effectively with customers. By teaching new workers how to interact successfully with customers before there is a problem, you can improve customer service before there is a problem. Maintain a policy that requires timely follow-up to guarantee customer satisfaction. Make it a priority to ensure that staff members are prompt in their responses to voicemails and emails.

2 - Exceed expectations

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Your customers depend on you to offer exceptional products and services. Your organization should constantly be working to improve the quality of the services it provides. To put it another way, it's better to underpromise and exceed expectations. If a customer is pleased with their experience, they are more inclined to purchase from that business again.

One strategy for genuinely surprising consumers is to deliver a product or service much more quickly than was anticipated. The customer will be appreciative of the very quick delivery that you provide. Even if you are certain that you can complete a customer's order a week early, you should nevertheless let them know that they should anticipate it by the end of the month.

3 - Ask for feedback

Customers will express their thoughts regardless of whether they are happy with the product or service or not. Requesting feedback from customers is a great way to show that you are sensitive to their needs. Put a survey or comment card box at the front desk so that we can evaluate how satisfied our customers are.

After you've zeroed in on your customers' specific needs with the help of their comments and criticism, you may be able to find the best solutions to their issues. Your company will enjoy increased levels of success depending on how well your product or service satisfies its needs.

It is essential to listen to all points of view and provide a prompt response, regardless of whether a statement is meant as praise or criticism. It is a huge error to solicit feedback without addressing the concerns raised. Negative comments from consumers might also provide vital information about how satisfied they are with a product or service as a whole.

4 - Connect

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Because of advances in technology, there are a greater variety of channels available than there have ever been in the past to establish relationships with customers. You can communicate with customers by utilizing any of the many online tools and social media channels that are now available. When communicating with customers on the internet, you should always be certain to encourage two-way communication. Ask customers questions and resolve any issues they may have.

Invest some time and effort into developing an engaging and high-quality website, and give some thought to starting a blog so that you can communicate with site visitors. Develop a relationship of trust with your customers via your online presence.

5 - Show appreciation

Develop a customer loyalty program that rewards repeat customers with discounted prices. Customer loyalty may be tracked in a number of ways, including the use of physical reward cards and digital loyalty management software.

Through participation in a customer loyalty program and the accumulation of points, customers have the opportunity to get rewards from your company. Once the customer reaches a particular point total, they are eligible to get an incentive. A buyer may get a discount on their subsequent purchase as a kind of incentive, for instance.

6 - Understand the customer journey

To successfully cultivate and preserve positive relationships with one's clientele, it is necessary to first have a grasp of the consumer's reasons for, and choices about, making a purchase. It is helpful to create a customer journey map that outlines the sales process from beginning to end and addresses the client's concerns at each point in order to better understand and meet the demands of your customers.

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This will allow you to better understand your customers and provide better service to them.

7 - Introduce yourself to the customer
In this day and age of increasing automation, customers place a high value on the ability to have a personal dialogue with a company. Clients should be given the phone number of a member of the front-line staff, and wherever possible, the staff member's name should be used. Making a personal connection with a customer is a great way to engage with them on a deeper level.

8 - Implement CRM software tools
You will be able to maintain a more accurate record of client records and interactions with the aid of customer relationship management (CRM) software, which will in turn enable you to provide superior service all around. By delegating routine tasks to automated processes, your employees will have more time to focus on developing meaningful relationships with customers.

9 - Market your customer service perks
You need to start promoting your company as one that serves consumers right away if you want to establish a name for your brand and cultivate a corporate culture that is centered on providing excellent service to customers.

Customers who value high-quality and attentive care are the kind of customers you are striving to get; as a result, you should promote the great quality of your customer service as frequently as you can. Include customer-friendly services in your offerings, such as a toll-free number that is staffed around the clock, an app that is simple to use, and rewards for customer loyalty.
10 - Match customer habits
Use the same channels of communication and approaches to problems that your customers use in order to simplify and

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streamline your interactions with them. Discover the retail establishments that are frequented by your ideal customers, and then set up business nearby. You may want to build corporate profiles on the social media platforms that are most often used by your target demographic in order to make it easier for consumers to find and connect with your brand.

11 - Respond right away

To successfully build and maintain a relationship with clients, it is essential to make yourself accessible to them and to communicate with them. When clients are aware that any questions or concerns they have will be attended to in a timely fashion, it is much simpler for businesses to maintain long-term relationships with those customers.

If you want to maintain the attention of your customers, you should aim to respond to their messages as quickly as you can, ideally before they become sidetracked from what they were doing or make the decision to go somewhere else. Make it a point to answer in a shorter amount of time than the length of time that was promised, and do everything in your power to meet or beat that goal.

12 - Set consistent quality controls

If your company adheres to stringent quality standards, you can be certain that your customers will be pleased with every aspect of their interactions with your company. You may ward off issues before they have an impact on consumers and portray a trustworthy, positive image to prospective buyers by instituting systems for quality assurance.

13 - Follow up regularly

In spite of the fact that the level of interest shown by customers may and will change over the course of time, it is necessary to have an open line of contact with your audience in order to keep a healthy company. Get back in touch with clients who haven't purchased from you in a while to see if

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there are any new offerings that would pique their interest in terms of either goods or services. You may reduce the possibility of them departing to a rival company if you reinforce the favorable opinion they currently have of your firm.

14 - Personalize all communications

Making use of a customer's first name in conversation is a simple but very efficient method for adding a level of personalization to conversations and establishing a relationship with them. Use a mailing list application to personalize your emails to customers by inserting their names in the subject lines; alternatively, you may go the extra mile and handwrite a personal message to them. When a customer feels as if they are a valued member of a company's "inner circle," they are more likely to remain loyal to that particular brand.

15 - Keep detailed customer files

Make use of the client's own information within the context of the discussion by making reference to the client's account and any relevant history. You will be able to provide superior assistance to clients, see patterns in their activities, and respond more rapidly to their inquiries if you keep detailed records of all of the transactions, interactions, and service requests they make.

If you maintain a record of every contact that a customer has with your business, you will be able to reflect, when appropriate, on previous experiences that customers have had with your brand and even inspire a feeling of nostalgia among your clientele.

16 - Prioritize customer experience

The level of success achieved by strategies aimed at preserving consumers' loyalty is directly proportional to the

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quality of the experiences provided to such customers. There is a 570% increase in revenue for companies that are able to provide a more fulfilling customer experience than their competitors, who are not as customer-centric.

When a firm makes an investment in its relationships with its customers, the company stands to gain three of the most valuable assets available to it: customer loyalty, customer retention, and positive word-of-mouth. They will have an immediate impact on the revenue and expenses of your firm. As customers become more loyal to your brand, there is an increase in both the lifetime value of a customer and the possibility that they would recommend your company to others.

Discover all there is to know about your customer's experience from start to finish so that you can provide seamless services. Customers will continue to do business with you for a longer period of time if they feel that their needs are being met.

17 - Create value for customers
If you want to establish a successful brand, it is imperative that you concentrate on the value that is perceived by customers. You may do this by:

- Being aware of the needs of your customers will allow you to better serve them. Discover the things that are important to your customers by paying attention to what they say, what they do, and how they react, and then look for ways to make your products better;
- Develop communities — engagement in online communities may have a major impact on key performance indicators (KPIs). Via this, the efficiency of corporate operations, the generation of new sources

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of revenue, and the contentment of the company's already-established clientele will all see significant gains. Because of this, customer communities are acknowledged as an essential component in the process of developing a relationship with consumers;

- To succeed, you must recognize your unique selling offer. It is essential to have a solid understanding of the value that your company's products and services provided to its customers;

- Invest in your loyal customers. Put the efforts of expanding your business into introducing new products and services that your most dedicated customers will find appealing. Without paying clients, it is impossible to maintain a successful company. They are the primary reason for our current success and the foundation for any planned growth in the future;

- It's crucial to educate your customers. In order to bring in new customers, businesses will use a diverse range of marketing approaches. Brands that make an investment in their consumers' education have a greater chance of earning the confidence of their customers. According to research, educating customers not only helps them feel more confident in a company, but also gives a crucial point of distinction for companies in terms of their customer service.

18 - Instill customer service etiquette

62% of customers globally have said that they would never make another purchase from the same business after having a negative interaction with the business's customer service. It is essential to implement customer service ethics into all aspects of your business, since providing outstanding service is the most effective approach to developing ties with existing

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customers.

The following are some recommendations for providing excellent customer service:

- **Don't be negative; instead, use positive phrases.**
  When customers believe that representatives of a brand are acting in an unprofessional or unfriendly manner, they often switch to a different brand in order to satisfy their needs. How a consumer feels they are being treated by the company accounts for 70% of their experience. Customer service is one of the most important aspects of any business, and one of the most important aspects of customer service, is understanding the appropriate vocabulary to use when engaging with customers. Your words create a first impression that sticks with the listener.

  It is recommended that phrases such as "my apologies" and "I am sorry" be used more often, whereas phrases such as "I don't know" and "No problem" should be avoided.

- **Be a better listener**
  Pay very careful attention to what it is that your customers are telling you. You need to do all in your ability to make your customers feel that they are valued, respected, and appreciated. You will have a better chance of gaining insight into the nature of the problem if you refrain from interrupting the customer. If you want to deliver service that is not just satisfactory but also memorable to your customers, it is vital to pay close attention to the needs, complaints, and ideas of those customers.

- **Be appreciative**
  When it comes to providing excellent service to

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customers, all it takes is two simple words: "thank you." When workers and customers use courteous expressions of appreciation like "thank you" as well as "please," the relationship between a firm and its clients develops stronger.

- **Show empathy**
  When interacting with customers, it is helpful to use compassionate language, be patient, and to show concern; this is particularly important if the customers are complaining or are having other troubles.

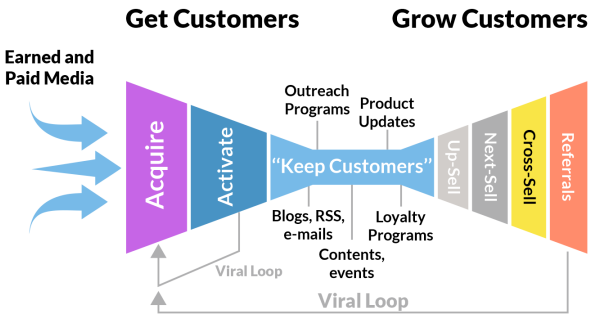
  When communicating with customers, it is essential to demonstrate real empathy; statements such as "I understand how hard it is to..." and "I'm very sorry to hear that..." may go a long way toward achieving this.

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VIRAL LOOP

A viral loop is created whenever a customer is happy with the Value Proposition that a company provides. Customers who are content with the products they have purchased are more inclined to tell others about their favorable experiences. The publicity (or brand reputation) that your company obtains as a result of this virality will come quickly and affordably.

The idea behind the viral loop, which was conceived by Steve Blank, is quite simple: how can we take advantage of satisfied customers who are already on board to expand the company? How can we make use of these current customers to increase awareness of our products and services? One way to think of this viral loop is as a word-of-mouth channel.



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CASE STUDY

STARBUCKS

Starbucks has, for the most part, been successful in its attempts to cultivate a long-lasting connection with its customer base. The firm has made itself widely accessible to customers by developing a unique atmosphere that is maintained throughout all of its locations. This provides customers with the assurance that they will have a pleasant experience regardless of where they choose to get their coffee.

As a result of this, Starbucks has evolved into an integral component of the everyday routines of its customers. The smartphone apps and loyalty programs that Starbucks has created keep customers coming back by rewarding them in unexpected ways for their continuing patronage.

GOOGLE VS. FACEBOOK IN CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIPS

Because Google and Facebook both have a substantial user base throughout the whole world, neither company is dependent on a particular market.

As a result of this, both companies are free to charge whatever prices they see fit, and their customers have no option but to comply with these new prices. Both companies

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have built auction-based, self-serve advertising solutions as part of their do-it-yourself (DIY) relationships with customers. As a result, a more fair description of them would be as Price Deciders instead of Price Acceptors.

Because Google has never had a single type of customer account for more than 10% of total revenue, the company maintains a high level of operational independence.

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CONCLUSION

The modern customer has far greater expectations. For instance, clients may be quite demanding of customer service departments with the requests that they make. If the satisfaction of the consumer is diminished in even the slightest amount, there is a significant possibility that a business will suffer. Receiving unfavorable feedback on a product or service, such as a review, is one way in which the reputation of a brand may be harmed.

Only the finest level of service will suffice if you are to meet the expectations of your customers. Creating a thorough strategy for dealing with any and all contacts with customers is one of the ways in which this objective may be accomplished. Keeping up positive relationships with your customers entails sticking to your value proposition.

Customer relationships are built on trust. You can't expect customers to respect you if they don't know anything about you, or how your company works. So it's important to develop a coherent image and brand that perfectly represents your company and its core values—and that customer responses to each page they visit reinforce your messages. Your customer journey website should let customers learn more about your business, and more specifically about their own interests.

In many contexts, customers might be likened to partners in the business. They will be able to do their job effectively by using your products and services. You are able to make money doing something that you like while also assisting them. In this sense, customer relationships are developed with the goal of producing mutual benefit for both parties involved.

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ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Daniel Pereira is a Brazilian-Canadian entrepreneur that has been designing and analyzing business models for over 15 years. You can read more about his journey as a Business Model Analyst **here**.



E-mail Daniel if you have any questions at: daniel@businessmodelanalyst.com
You can connect with Daniel at Linkedin: https://www.linkedin.com/in/dpereirabr/

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